and logistics operations with minimal human intervention. This figure encapsulates China's emphasis on multi-role UAV design, merging heavy-lift capability, endurance, and advanced autonomy for strategic aerial operations.



Figure 5.8 Tengden TW-356 (2020).⏎

5.6.2.7 Ghatak UCAV (2022)

The Ghatak UCAV (unmanned combat aerial vehicle), developed by India's Defense Research and Development Organization (DRDO) under the Aeronautical Development Establishment (ADE), represents a landmark achievement in India's journey toward indigenous stealth and autonomous combat drone technology. Officially initiated in 2022 after years of conceptual development under the "AURA" (autonomous unmanned research aircraft) project, the Ghatak embodies India's entry into the realm of next-generation stealth UCAVs designed for precision strikes, deep penetration missions, and high-threat reconnaissance operations.

The Ghatak UCAV features a flying-wing configuration, similar to advanced platforms like the US B-2 Spirit and France's Dassault Neuron, enabling low radar cross-section (RCS) and superior aerodynamic performance. Built using radar-absorbent composite materials and equipped with a serpentine engine intake for infrared and radar signature suppression,